5-MINUTE SELF-CHECK

Are you ready to put AI to work?

For professionals, business owners and teams. Assess one workflow, then choose your next move.

Choose one task or workflow before you begin. Check a box only when the statement is true today and you can give an example. For a team, confirm answers with the workflow owner. Unchecked means a next step, not a failure.

01 / Purpose and value

- [ ] **I have a specific problem to solve.**
  Example: drafting proposals, summarizing research or following up on enquiries.
- [ ] **I know how the task works today.**
  I can describe the inputs, steps, output and who uses the result.
- [ ] **I have a baseline to compare against.**
  I know the current time, cost or error rate for this task.
- [ ] **I have defined a useful outcome.**
  Example: reduce drafting time while keeping accuracy and quality steady.

02 / Tools and skills

- [ ] **I can access a suitable, permitted AI tool.**
  Check employer rules, account permissions and any approval needed.
- [ ] **I know what to delegate and what to keep human.**
  AI can assist with a draft; a person stays responsible for the final result.
- [ ] **I can give clear instructions and assess the output.**
  I can explain the goal, context, constraints and what a good answer looks like.
- [ ] **I have time and support to practise.**
  I have a short learning plan or access to a colleague, facilitator or guide.

CHECKLIST / CONTINUED

Can you test it responsibly?

Use the same workflow you chose on page 1. Check only what is in place now.

03 / Information and safeguards

- [ ] **I have suitable information or examples to use.**
  Inputs are relevant, reasonably accurate and available for this task.
- [ ] **I know what information must stay out of the tool.**
  Identify personal, client, confidential and proprietary information first.
- [ ] **I have checked how the tool handles my information.**
  Review relevant retention, training-use settings, access and sharing controls.
- [ ] **A person will verify results before they are used.**
  Check facts, calculations, sources and context; watch for biased assumptions.

04 / Pilot and adoption

- [ ] **Someone owns the pilot and its decisions.**
  For an individual, this may be you. For a team, name an accountable owner.
- [ ] **The pilot has a clear scope, budget and end date.**
  Start with one manageable workflow and sample or approved information.
- [ ] **I have a fallback and know when to stop.**
  Keep the original process available and define when human help is required.
- [ ] **I will measure results and decide what comes next.**
  Compare with the baseline, gather feedback and decide to adapt, scale or stop.

Before live use: if tool permission, information handling or human review is unresolved, use synthetic examples in an approved environment while you close the gaps.

YOUR NEXT MOVE

Turn readiness into action.

Count your checked boxes across pages 1 and 2. Your total is out of 16.

Need help? Explore AI consulting, workshops and hack sprints on our website.

My readiness score: ____ / 16 | Date:

0-5 / Build the foundations

Choose one useful task, learn the basics and confirm which tools and information you may use.

6-11 / Close the gaps

Address unchecked items, then design a small, supervised test with a clear success measure.

12-16 / Prepare a focused pilot

You have many foundations in place. Confirm safeguards, run the pilot and evaluate results before expanding.

This score is a reflection tool, not a validated assessment or approval to deploy AI. A high score does not override unresolved safeguards.

The one workflow I will test:

The most important gap I will close first:

Success measure and baseline (e.g., minutes per draft before / after):

Owner and next review date: